

ters. If terms like VCB and Component don't make sense to you right now, we'd suggest you take a step back and read Chapter 2 again.

4.1 Creating Your First Floor Plan

Let us assume, for the rest of this chapter, that you're building yourself a shiny new home. In the previous chapter, we went through the process of building a house, but there was one catch—that house was, but an empty shell. The walls had no thickness, no rooms, storeys or anything that may be considered part of the house's interiors. This time round, we won't ignore that bit.

4.1.1 Setting Up

We'll be using the Value Control Box (VCB) a lot here, so the first thing we need to do is set up the default units of measurement. You don't really *need* to do this—just type in 12 m no matter what your default unit, and SketchUp recognises it as 12 metres. However, if you just type 12 and your default unit is inches, SketchUp will recognise it as inches. Typing 12 is undoubtedly the more preferable option (if you're using the metric system), which is why we're going to Window > Preferences > Template and choosing Metric-Meters-3D under Drawing Template.

If you haven't done it already, enable the Large Tool Set—this will give you better access to tools you're going to use often.

If you have a paper drawing of the floor plan you're going to design, that helps plenty. And if you are indeed familiar with architecture, you can import your floor plan from software like AutoCAD and skip this step altogether.

Finally, we start working in the Top view—choose Camera > Standard Views > Top. Also choose Camera > Parallel projection—using Perspective won't give you the “technical drawing” experience we're looking for. While you're in this view, resist the temptation to use the Orbit tool. Naturally, you've just used it—go back to Camera > Standard Views > Top to get back to the top view. What you really need to use here are the Zoom (scroll wheel) and Pan ([Shift] + Middle-click + Drag) tools.